

The Prevention Case

An ADSB campaign package: getting disability income onto the FCSSAA floor

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · St. Albert, Alberta · 2026 · Original ADSB material. Free to read, print, adapt, and submit.

The deadline is real: on or before Saturday, September 26, 2026. FCSSAA's rule is that a resolution must be received at least 60 days before the Annual General Meeting, which is held during the IMPACT 2026 conference in Edmonton, November 25 to 27. September 26 is the last safe day.

Resolutions go to Mellissa Kraft, Executive Director, at director@fcssaa.org. After September 26 the only remaining route is an emergent resolution, which is harder and not guaranteed.

What this is

Once a year, the Family and Community Support Services Association of Alberta — FCSSAA, the body that ties together nearly 200 member FCSS programs across Alberta — votes on resolutions: formal asks that the whole association then carries to the Government of Alberta. Past resolutions have advocated for a provincial poverty-reduction strategy (2014) and an affordable-housing plan for Albertans (2016). They pass, and they become the association's marching orders.

We want one on disability income this year. This package is everything you need to make that happen in your town: the argument, the resolution itself, two ready-to-send emails, and the people to send them to.

This package is built from our own campaign's evidence and the government's published numbers. We don't put our name on borrowed work, so every part of it is ours to stand behind.

Why FCSS is the right room

The whole case fits in one line: prevention is cheaper than collapse, and disability income is prevention.

That is not our slogan — it is the founding logic of FCSS. Family and Community Support Services exist to catch a problem upstream, before it becomes a crisis a community has to absorb. When disability income is lowered, when a couple's rate is cut, when a federal benefit is reduced by a provincial offset, the need does not disappear. It relocates — to the food bank, the housing line, the crisis phone, and the FCSS-funded supports built to prevent those very things. That makes disability income a prevention question, and a fair one to put to FCSSAA.

FCSSAA has been here before. Resolution 2022-01, submitted by Lac La Biche County FCSS, was about people on income supports being unable to reach Alberta Supports by phone or online, and about the workload that fell on community agencies and rural FCSS offices as a result. It carried. FCSSAA now reprints it in its own Resolution Manual as the sample resolution shown to every member program. That is our

argument, already inside their house. Resolution 2016-02, on an affordable housing plan for Albertans, was closed with the note that it would continue to form part of the association's advocacy work.

A second example is already in motion, in the same households, at the same time. Alberta has changed how rent is set in subsidized and community housing to a flat 30 per cent of a household's total income, and it is steadily removing the income that used to be left out of that calculation. A \$1,200-a-year exemption for households with dependent children is already being removed as tenants reach their annual review; beginning January 1, 2027 the Canada Child Benefit and the Alberta Child and Family Benefit will be counted as income for the Rent Assistance Benefit, followed by all community-housing households on January 1, 2028 (Social Housing Accommodation Regulation, AR 244/1994, as amended by AR 122/2025). The effect is that families with children — including many disabled parents and parents of disabled children — pay more rent and are left with less for food, utilities, and everyday costs. That shortfall does not vanish; it lands on food banks, utility assistance, and the same FCSS-funded supports meant to prevent those crises. It is the same pattern as the disability-income changes, reaching the same families from a second direction.

A note on scope. The housing change belongs in the rationale as evidence of load, not in the resolution's operative clause. FCSSAA requires a resolution to address one clearly defined concern, and ours is disability income.

The rules that shape everything

Who can file. Only an FCSS Board, or a Municipal or Métis Settlement Council, that is a member of FCSSAA and in good standing. Associate members may not submit. Not individuals. Not campaigns. Not advocacy organizations, however large. That rule is the same for everyone outside the FCSS system.

Council has to endorse it. FCSSAA lists, as a deficiency that can send a resolution back, the absence of any indication that it was endorsed by the council of the sponsoring municipality. An FCSS board saying yes is usually not the end of the process. It has to reach a council agenda.

Which moves the real deadline forward. Councils meet roughly twice a month and agendas close about a week ahead. To be endorsed and filed by September 26, the ask has to land in early September at the latest. Treat the first week of September as your deadline, not the twenty-sixth.

Co-sponsorship is allowed. Resolution 2016-06 was filed by six FCSS programs together. If two or three of the councils below say yes, they can file as one.

So the only way this reaches the floor is if a councillor or an FCSS board sponsors it, and the only way that happens is if they hear from us. That is the whole play: we are the megaphone, your council is the hand that files the paper. One sponsor is all it takes.

What happens if it passes

A resolution carries on a two-thirds vote of the registered delegates. Once carried, it goes to the relevant FCSSAA standing committee, which develops a policy statement; the board approves it; and the statement is

sent to the appropriate provincial ministry. FCSSAA then collects the responses and publishes a status inventory on its website, including what follow-up it will take where the advocacy was not successful. A carried resolution stays in effect for five years.

That publication step matters to us for its own sake. Whatever the province answers, the answer goes on the record in public.

How to act, about 15 minutes

- 1. Start with your own municipality.** Search “[your town] council contact” and “[your town] FCSS.” Your own town’s voice carries the most weight.
- 2. Send the email below** — paste it, add your name, send. Ask them to sponsor the resolution, have council endorse it, and file it before September 26.
- 3. Then write the warm list.** The towns further down already spoke up about the disability-income changes. They are the most likely yes.

Send to a councillor, an FCSS board representative, and the FCSS program staff where you can. More doors, better odds.

Email 1 — to a municipal councillor

Subject: Please sponsor an FCSSAA resolution on disability income, due September 26

Dear Councillor [name],

I’m a resident of [municipality]. I’m writing to ask you to sponsor a resolution at this year’s FCSSAA Annual General Meeting. Resolutions must reach FCSSAA at least 60 days before the AGM, which puts the filing deadline at September 26, 2026, at director@fcssaa.org.

I understand FCSSAA may return a resolution if there is no indication that council endorsed it, so I am asking you to bring it to council in time for that endorsement.

Recent changes to Alberta’s disability income are pushing more disabled Albertans toward poverty. When income falls, the need doesn’t vanish; it lands on food banks, housing programs, and the FCSS-funded supports meant to prevent those crises in the first place.

FCSS exists to strengthen people and communities through prevention, which makes this a fair and fitting thing for FCSSAA to carry. FCSSAA has carried closely related work before, including Resolution 2022-01 on barriers to accessing Alberta Supports services. The proposed resolution is attached. I would be grateful if you would bring it forward through your council or local FCSS board before the September 26 deadline.

Thank you for your time, and for standing up for our community.

[Your name] · [Your town] · [Phone or email, if you wish]

Email 2 — to FCSS staff, an advisory committee member, or a provincial board member

Subject: Support for a proposed FCSSAA resolution on disability income and prevention

Dear [name],

As someone involved in Family and Community Support Services, you see the link between income security and the demand placed on local preventive services every day. I’m writing to ask you to support, and where you can help bring forward, a resolution for this year’s FCSSAA AGM. Resolutions must be received at least

60 days before the AGM, so the filing deadline is September 26, 2026, at director@fcssaa.org.

The proposed resolution asks FCSSAA to advocate that disability income assistance meet basic needs as measured by the Market Basket Measure plus the added costs of living with a disability, preserve the full value of the federal Canada Disability Benefit, maintain access to health and disability-related benefits, and be designed so it prevents rather than shifts hardship onto municipal and community services.

This is squarely within the preventive, community-building purpose of FCSS, and it follows the line of Resolution 2022-01 on barriers to accessing Alberta Supports services. I would be grateful if you would discuss it with your local FCSS board, advisory committee, or regional representative, including the council endorsement step.

Thank you for your ongoing commitment to stronger, more inclusive communities.

[Your name] · [Phone or email]

THE RESOLUTION

Topic: Disability Income as Prevention — Protecting Community Wellbeing Through Adequate Disability Income Support

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Family and Community Support Services Association of Alberta call on the Government of Alberta to ensure that disability income assistance — under both the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) and the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) — provides income that meets or exceeds the Market Basket Measure (Canada’s official poverty line) together with the additional costs of living with a disability; preserves the full value of the federal Canada Disability Benefit without an offsetting reduction in provincial benefits; maintains access to health and disability-related benefits regardless of a person’s employment income; and is designed so that it prevents, rather than shifts, avoidable hardship onto municipal and community-based preventive services.

RATIONALE

Family and Community Support Services exist to strengthen individuals, families, and communities through prevention. When people fall into poverty, housing instability, food insecurity, or isolation, the demand lands on community-based and FCSS-funded services. Adequate, stable disability income is one of the most direct preventive supports available, because it keeps people out of the crises those services are built to address.

This is a province-wide matter, not a local one. AISH and ADAP are provincial programs delivered in every community in Alberta, and FCSS programs serve municipalities and Métis Settlements covering more than 99 per cent of Albertans. A reduction in disability income therefore reaches the caseload of effectively every member program at once, and it does so through direct service delivery: intake, referral, emergency assistance, transportation support, and the staff time spent helping people navigate a provincial system they can no longer reach on their own.

People with disabilities carry costs other Albertans do not: disability-related transportation, assistive technology, medical supplies, specialized supports, and accessibility. Income support should therefore be measured against the Market Basket Measure plus those additional costs. As of the 2026 benefit period, the Government of Alberta reports a core ADAP financial benefit of \$1,740 per month; beginning in the August 2026 benefit period, two adults in the same household who each receive disability income assistance each receive 88 per cent of the maximum individual benefit. Where disability income sits below the Market Basket Measure, or where the value of a federal disability benefit is reduced by a provincial offset, the predictable result is greater poverty, greater instability, and greater reliance on municipal and community services.

The government’s published figures also show a trade-off in work incentives. An AISH recipient may keep only the first \$350 of monthly employment income before deductions begin, compared with \$700 under ADAP — and \$1,100 for an ADAP recipient with dependent children, or \$1,500 for a cohabiting partner under either program. A low earnings exemption limits how much a person can lift their own income through work, which runs against both employment participation and the prevention of poverty.

FCSSAA has carried closely related work before. Resolution 2022-01, submitted by Lac La Biche County FCSS, addressed barriers facing people on income supports in reaching Alberta Supports services, and the added workload that fell on community agencies and rural FCSS offices as a result. Resolution 2016-02, on an affordable housing plan for Albertans, was closed with the note that it would continue to form part of FCSSAA's advocacy work.

A 2025 lived-experience policy brief on the Canada Disability Benefit, led by Brittany Finlay through the University of Calgary's Disability Policy Research Program, urges the Government of Alberta to reverse its treatment of the Canada Disability Benefit as non-exempt income (the clawback) so that recipients receive the additional federal support. A 2026 University of Calgary School of Public Policy briefing paper, Reforming Disability Income Support in Alberta for Employment and Equity (Jardine, Fyie and Zwicker), further finds that pairing adequate income security with higher earnings exemptions and meaningful employment supports is a more effective, evidence-based approach to advancing both income security and employment participation than reducing benefit levels and earnings exemptions. Together, these measures would protect income at the household level and reduce downstream demand on community supports.

When people with disabilities have income that meets their needs, stable supports, and a real path to participate in work and community life, they are far less likely to reach the point of crisis. Protecting disability income is therefore not outside the FCSS mandate — it is the clearest expression of it.

Note for the sponsoring council or FCSS board

This resolution is written to meet FCSSAA's resolution criteria: it addresses one clear concern (the adequacy and protection of disability income), it affects the majority of FCSS programs, it has a direct impact on FCSS service delivery, and it sits within the FCSS prevention mandate. It follows the required BE IT RESOLVED / RATIONALE format.

Please confirm council endorsement before filing, since a resolution may be returned where that endorsement is not evident. Co-sponsorship by more than one municipality is permitted and has been used before.

Please keep it neutral and constructive on submission — it is written as a policy ask, not as criticism of any government or party, and the neutral version is the one that carries. If the Resolutions Committee asks for it to be narrowed to a single element, that is normal. The clawback line is the one we would keep.

Who to contact

Warm list — towns that already spoke up on the disability-income changes

Start here. These councils have already passed pause motions or written to the Minister, so they understand the issue.

- **Barrhead** — Cllr Steven Fylyshtan sfylyshtan@barrhead.ca · Cllr Anthony Oswald aoswald@barrhead.ca · FCSS staff reception@barrheadfcss.org
- **Calgary** — Cllr Nathaniel Schmidt (also FCSSAA board) ward8@calgary.ca · Mayor Jeromy Farkas mayor@calgary.ca · staff CommunityWellbeingPartners@calgary.ca
- **Camrose** — Cllr Agnes Hoveland ahoveland@camrose.ca · Cllr Joy-Anne Murphy jmurphy@camrose.ca · Director Lyndel Kasa director@camrosefcss.ca
- **Claresholm** — Director Barbara Bell fcss.director@claresholm.ca · Cllr David Knox david.knox@claresholm.ca · Cllr Kandice Meister kandice.meister@claresholm.ca · Cllr Seth Wagner seth.wagner@claresholm.ca
- **Cold Lake** — Director Kim Schmitz kschmitz@coldlake.com · Cllr Raymond Cowell rcowell@coldlake.com
- **Cochrane** — Theresa Bolton (FCSSAA board) fcss@cochrane.ca · Manager Kim Krawec kim.krawec@cochrane.ca · Cllr Marni Singh marni.singh@cochrane.ca
- **Edmonton** — Judy Smith judy.smith@edmonton.ca · Cllr Jo-Anne Wright jo-anne.wright@edmonton.ca · Cllr Keren Tang keren.tang@edmonton.ca
- **Grande Prairie** — Cllr Brian Peterson (FCSSAA board) · Director Melodie McCracken fcss@countypg.ab.ca · Mayor Jackie Clayton jclayton@cityofgp.com
- **Lethbridge** — Danielle Lenaour danielle.lenaour@lethbridge.ca · Cllr Belinda Crowson belinda.crowson@lethbridge.ca · Mayor Blaine Hyggen mayor@lethbridge.ca · Cllr Jenn Schmidt-Rempel jenn.schmidt-rempe@lethbridge.ca
- **Medicine Hat** — FCSS Director Shona Dickie shodic@medicinehat.ca · 403-502-8718
- **Red Deer** — Manager Bobby-Jo Stannard culturemailbox@reddeer.ca · Cllr Cassandra Curtis cassandra.curtis@reddeer.ca · Cllr Jaelene Tweedle jaelene.tweedle@reddeer.ca
- **Rocky Mountain House** — Mayor Shane Boniface sboniface@trmh.ca · Manager Andrea Hardy fcssmanager@trmh.ca
- **St. Albert** — Manager Connie Smigielski csmigielski@stalbert.ca · Cllr Shelley Biermanski sbiermanski@stalbert.ca · Cllr Amanda Patrick apatrick@stalbert.ca

FCSSAA provincial board — worth a note as well

President Kayla Blanchette (Bonnyville) bdfcss@town.bonnyville.ab.ca · Nathaniel Schmidt (Calgary) ward8@calgary.ca · George Glazier (Paintearth County) gglazier@countypaintearth.ca · Philip Penrod

(Beaumont) keep.reaching.beaumont@gmail.com · Darlene Reimer (Athabasca County) info@athabascacounty.com · Kathleen Waxer (Jasper) kwaxer@jasper-alberta.ca · Tara Gilchrist (Canmore) tara.gilchrist@canmore.ca · Zakk Morrison (Barons-Eureka-Warner) zakk.morrison@fcss.ca · Tracy Proulx (Westlock) tproulx@westlock.ca · Crystal Tremblay (Smoky River, Secretary) srfcss@live.ca

To reach your regional representative, FCSSAA directs enquiries to assistant@fcssaa.org.

Sourcing, so every figure holds up

- **ADAP core benefit (\$1,740/month), the 88% couple rate (from the August 2026 benefit period), and the published earnings exemptions (\$350 AISH; \$700 ADAP; \$1,100 ADAP parent; \$1,500 cohabiting partner):** Government of Alberta, Alberta Disability Assistance Program page, alberta.ca — verified August 2026.
- **Resolution process, the 60-day filing rule, who may submit, the council-endorsement requirement, the one-concern rule, the two-thirds vote, the five-year term, and the emergent-resolution route:** FCSSAA Resolution Manual 2025, fcssaa.org — verified August 2026.
- **Resolutions 2022-01 (Lac La Biche), 2016-02 (affordable housing), 2016-06 (co-sponsorship), and the 2014 poverty-reduction resolution:** FCSSAA Resolutions page, fcssaa.org — verified August 2026.
- **Conference and AGM dates (Edmonton, November 25 to 27, 2026):** FCSSAA conference page, fcssaa.org — verified August 2026.
- **Nearly 200 member FCSS programs** (FCSSAA reports almost 200 member programs; its board portal states 208 programs representing 319 municipalities) **and coverage of more than 99 per cent of Albertans:** fcssaa.org — verified August 2026.
- **The Canada Disability Benefit clawback:** “Losing the Canada Disability Benefit means losing hope for many Albertans,” lived-experience brief led by Brittany Finlay, University of Calgary Disability Policy Research Program, July 2025 — dipo.ca/updates/aish-cdb-brief.
- **Income security paired with employment supports and higher earnings exemptions:** MacKenna Jardine, Ken Fyie and Jennifer Zwicker, Reforming Disability Income Support in Alberta for Employment and Equity, University of Calgary School of Public Policy, Briefing Paper Vol. 19:07, June 2026 — policyschool.ca (HSP140).
- **Subsidized-housing rent changes** (30% of total income; child-benefit and dependent-child exemptions removed; Jan 1 2027 for the Rent Assistance Benefit and Jan 1 2028 for community housing): Social Housing Accommodation Regulation, AR 244/1994, as amended by AR 122/2025, with exemptions set by Ministerial Order; implementation confirmed by housing management bodies — Cvida, cvida.ca/shar.
- **Market Basket Measure:** Statistics Canada’s official poverty line; the resolution asks that income be measured against it plus disability-related costs, stated as the standard rather than a fixed dollar figure.

- **The prevention-and-demand logic:** ADSB campaign documentation (Payment Instability, Access Barrier, Alberta Housing Crisis, and Human Cost findings).

What is not in here, on purpose: no member names, no unverified dollar claims presented as settled, and nothing that reads as a partisan attack. That is what keeps it ours and keeps it eligible.

Ask in writing. Keep the answer. And this time, ask them to carry it for us.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | August 2026

albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com